



Guide Your Own Usability Test

Digital Accessibility by WeCo

Ready to jump in and create your Guide-Your-Own Usability test? This document will assist you in how to get started, defining your goals, crafting your list of tasks, and running your test.

Getting Started

First, make sure you have any materials you need. For example, you'll need:

- The website, app, or software you're testing
- A virtual or physical testing environment (Teams, Zoom, etc.)
- A form tool (for unmoderated testing) or a notetaking platform (for moderated testing).

Next, make sure to determine how many testers you've hired and how much time you will have with each tester. This will help you as you answer the questions in this document.

Define your goals

What are your goals for this test? Some examples of goals include:

- Can users with disabilities find information efficiently and easily?
- Are the user flows intuitive?
- Can someone using assistive technology (screen readers, voice recognition, etc.) navigate the site as easily as users who don't use assistive technology?
- Is the visual design appealing and approachable for users with cognitive disabilities?

Next, determine what pages or user flows you would like to test. Consider the following while making your decision:

- What are the most viewed pages on the website, app, or software?
- What are the most important tasks that user needs to complete while using your product?
- Are there any recent changes made to your website or product that you would like to see users interact with?
- Are there any areas that are common pain points for users accessing your website or product?

Lastly, consider if you would like to hear the perspective of someone living with a certain disability or disability type. Depending upon how many testers you're hiring, you may be able to hear from multiple disability perspectives. The four primary types of disabilities include:

- **Cognitive:** Disabilities that impact how people take in information. These may/may not be described as neurodivergent. Examples: Autism, Attention-deficit/hyperactivity disorder (ADHD), clinical depression, traumatic brain injury, and memory disorders.
- **Hearing:** Disabilities that impact a person's auditory experience. Examples: hearing loss and deafness.
- **Mobility:** Disabilities that impact how a person is able to use their hands in order to access computers, tablets, and phones. Examples: Spinal cord injuries, Arthritis, Multiple Sclerosis, and Cerebral Palsy.
- **Sight:** Disabilities that impact a person's ability to take in information visually. Examples: Blindness, color blindness, and low vision.

Some example scenarios may include:

- You're testing software with lots of interactive maps, and you'd like to make sure that users with limited fine motor skills can easily navigate the maps.
- You hired two testers, and you'd like to compare how a sighted user with a cognitive disability interacts with your website versus how a blind or low-vision user uses their screen reader to navigate the site.
- You're testing a video platform and want to ensure the videos are accessible for people who are deaf.
- You're testing a mental health care website, and you want to make sure the design is easy to navigate and aesthetically pleasing for users with cognitive disabilities.

Craft your task list/scenarios

Before crafting your task list, determine how many tasks you will likely have time for. Each task should take a tester up to 10 minutes. With a 10-minute buffer and 10 minutes for debriefing after the test is complete, a tester should be able to complete around 10 tasks in 2 hours.

Based on the goals you created in the previous section, you can now craft your list of tasks or scenarios! Some general tips for crafting tasks include:

- Create realistic tasks that are common for your users (or potential users) to complete.
- Avoid creating a list of instructions for testers to follow. Instead, the task should be written as a goal they want to complete on the site.
- Use a neutral, unbiased tone, and avoid using technical jargon.

Some examples of good and bad tasks include:

- Good example: You're new to Minnesota, and you'd like to find local concerts to attend. Find an upcoming jazz concert with tickets available.
- Bad example: On the home page, navigate to the section that says, "News and Events." Select the "Learn more" button and find the news story about the upcoming concert.

After each task, include a list of questions about their experience completing the task. Be sure to collect both **qualitative** and **quantitative** data. For example,

- **Qualitative:** Ask open-ended questions about the user's experience, such as
 - What was your experience like completing this task?
 - What did you like/not like about completing this task?
 - If you could change one thing about this feature, what would it be?
 - (For users using assistive technology) How was your experience navigating this feature using your assistive technology?
- **Quantitative:** Ask yes/no questions or have testers rate their experience on a scale (for example, 1-5 or Strongly Disagree to Strongly agree). This may include:
 - Did you complete the task?
 - How easy or difficult was completing this task? (Very easy, easy, somewhat easy, neutral, somewhat difficult, difficult, very difficult, I wasn't able to complete this task)
 - On a scale from 1 to 5, one being very unlikely and 5 being very likely, how likely are you to recommend this website to a friend?

Running the test

Once your test is put together, you'd want to determine if you'd like to run a **moderated** or **unmoderated** test.

1. If your team has limited time or wishes to run tests asynchronously, you may decide to do an **unmoderated test**. This requires your team to create a form that includes all tasks and questions for every part of the test. Testers will fill out the form on their own and unobserved, and you will receive their responses. Remember to ask testers to time how long it takes to complete each task.
2. You may decide you'd prefer to run a **moderated** test. In this scenario, you would assign a test moderator that reads the test aloud to the tester, and your team can watch the tester complete the task. This allows the moderator or team to ask the tester questions about their experience after each task.
3. WeCo's Guided Usability tests are a **mix of both**. We send the task list and all questions for each test as a form to our testers. Afterwards, we schedule a post-test debrief meeting with all of our testers to ask any clarifying questions about their responses.